CITY COLLEGE OF

SAN FERNANDO PAMPANGA

City of San Fernando (P)

PetSona: A Personality-Based Pet Recommendation System to Promote Responsible Pet Ownership and Reduce Abandonment

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November 2025

Table of Contents

Title Page ..... **i**

Table of Contents ..... **ii**

List of Figures ..... **iii**

CHAPTER I ..... 1 - 8

Background of the Study 1

Statement of the Problem 4

General Problem 4

Specific Problems 4

Objectives of the Study 5

General Objective 5

Specific Objectives 5

Significance of the Study 6

Scope and Delimitations 7

CHAPTER II ..... 9 - 15

Related Literature 9

Related Studies 12

Synthesis 14

References 16

Appendices i

Appendix A. Authorization and Request Letters i

Appendix B. Questionnaire iii

Appendix C. Survey and Interview Results with Interpretation xi

List of Figures

Figure 1: Age Group xi

Figure 2: Gender xii

Figure 3: Location (Barangay, City) xiii

Figure 4: Types of Pet xiv

Figure 5: Length of Pet Ownership xv

Figure 6: Reasons for Choosing Pet xvi

Figure 7: Consideration of Lifestyle or Personality Before Choosing a Pet xvii

Figure 8: Respondents' Personality Descriptions xviii

Figure 9: Compatibility with Current Pets xix

Figure 10: Time Spent at Home with Pets xx

Figure 11: Adequacy of Home Space for Pets xxi

Figure 12: Frequency of Pet Check-ups xxii

Figure 13: Pet Vaccination Status xxiii

Figure 14: Methods of Pet Grooming Among Respondents xxiv

Figure 15: Willingness to Use a Pet–Owner Matching System xxv

CHAPTER I

Background of the Study

In the present day, people's attachment to their pets reflects one of the many ways love can manifest (Applebaum et al., 2021). As Charmaraman et al. (2022) note, the term “pet” has evolved to include animals that receive both physical and emotional care from families, acknowledging their importance to overall well-being. Many individuals adopt pets for companionship (Holland et al., 2022). Moreover, Hussein et al. (2021) emphasize that owning a pet enhances social interaction, increases physical activity, and reduces anxiety. Pet ownership continues to be a lasting representation of the bond between humans and animals (Scoresby et al., 2021).

Pet ownership has increased globally due to lifestyle changes, career priorities, and emotional needs (Cuyop et al., 2023). However, this rise also highlights an important concern—compatibility between an owner’s personality, lifestyle, and the type of pet they choose. Northrope et al. (2025) emphasize that time, financial capacity, and commitment should always be evaluated before acquiring a pet. When these factors are ignored, the risk of neglect and abandonment grows.

From a psychological standpoint, the Big Five Personality Traits—openness, conscientiousness, extraversion, agreeableness, and neuroticism—play a major role in determining suitable pets for individuals. For example, highly active or extroverted people may be more compatible with energetic dogs, while introverted or calm individuals might prefer cats or small, low-maintenance animals (Finka et al., 2019; Powell et al., 2023). Considering personality alignment reduces the risk of owner dissatisfaction and animal abandonment.

Pet abandonment poses serious welfare and public health concerns. According to Perdomo et al. (2021), abandoned pets face hunger, untreated illness, and exposure to harsh environments. Communities are also at risk due to stray-related accidents and potential rabies transmission (FOUR PAWS International, 2023). In the Philippines, the issue of stray animals remains significant, especially in urban areas where dogs and cats dominate household pet choices. Many strays suffer from neglect and lack of medical care, increasing the spread of zoonotic diseases (Carbungco, 2023; Carbungco, 2025).

Recent data from the **City Agriculture and Veterinary Office (CAVO)** further emphasizes this concern. In 2024 alone, **861 stray dogs were captured** under the Askal Operation, but **only 62 were returned** to their owners, while **799 were euthanized** due to overpopulation and disease risk (CAVO, 2024). These figures highlight the urgent need for stronger pet responsibility initiatives and preventive strategies against abandonment.

Another growing issue is the lack of accessible short-term care options. Owners often face challenges when work, travel, or emergencies prevent them from caring for their pets. Research shows that structured temporary fostering and respite programs improve animal welfare and reduce abandonment rates (Gunter et al., 2023; Phillips & Gunter, 2024).

Incompatibility between owners and pets also contributes to neglect. People may adopt pets with high maintenance or exercise needs without adequate preparation, leading to stress and eventual abandonment.

Veterinarians and animal welfare organizations therefore advise considering factors such as lifestyle, space, budget, and long-term commitment before adopting a pet.

Given these issues, this study proposes **PetSona: A Personality-Based Pet Recommendation System to Promote Responsible Pet Ownership and Reduce Abandonment**. The study helps potential owners identify pets suited to their personality, lifestyle, and capacity for care.

Statement of the Problem

General Problem

Pet abandonment remains a pressing concern, reflecting gaps in responsible pet ownership. When pets are neglected or abandoned, they suffer from malnutrition, untreated illnesses, and unsafe conditions. At the same time, communities face the consequences of increased stray populations, including public health risks such as rabies, road accidents, and safety concerns. Despite the recognized emotional and social value of pets, irresponsible ownership continues to drive abandonment, signaling the need for stronger awareness and support systems.

Specific Problems

1. Many pet owners acquire animals without considering their lifestyle, available resources, or personality fit, leading to difficulties in providing appropriate care and, eventually, abandonment.
2. Owners who face illness, work commitments, or travel often neglect their pets due to the absence of accessible and reliable short-term care options. Without responsible arrangements, pets are left unattended or abandoned.
3. Some pet owners fail to provide essential medical care, including vaccinations, deworming, and regular check-ups. This neglect not only endangers the pets' health but also increases the risk of transmissible diseases such as rabies, affecting both animals and the community.
4. The overwhelming volume of online resources makes it difficult for owners to identify credible guidance, often resulting in poor decisions that compromise pets' health and welfare.

5. There is limited awareness of the connection between personality traits and pet behavior, resulting in mismatched adoptions that increase the likelihood of abandonment.

Objectives of the Study

General Objective

This study aims to develop a personality-based pet recommendation system that promotes responsible pet ownership and reduces pet abandonment.

Specific Objectives

1. To encourage pet owners to consider their lifestyle, resources, and personality when acquiring a pet, ensuring compatibility and long-term care.
2. To raise awareness about the importance of planning for temporary care during situations such as illness, work commitments, or travel, minimizing the risk of neglect or abandonment.
3. To emphasize the significance of providing essential preventive health care for pets, including vaccinations, deworming, and regular veterinary check-ups, to safeguard both animal and public health.
4. To guide pet owners in identifying credible information sources on pet care and proper handling, reducing reliance on inconsistent or misleading advice.
5. To promote responsible pet ownership by increasing awareness of the relationship between personality compatibility and pet behavior, fostering compassion, and encouraging lifelong commitment to animal welfare.

Significance of the Study

Potential Pet Owners:

To assist potential pet owners in the Philippines, make informed and responsible decisions when choosing pets. By providing a web-based application system that matches owners with compatible species and breeds including cats, dogs, birds, reptiles, amphibians, small mammals, and ornamental fish the study seeks to improve pet-owner compatibility, reduce risks of neglect or abandonment, and ensure better welfare for animals.

Veterinarians, Pet Shops, and Animal Welfare Organizations:

To provide assistance to veterinarians, breeders, and pet shop owners in providing science-based recommendations to potential pet owners. It serves as a tool for these professionals to educate clients about proper pet care, long-term responsibilities, and lifestyle suitability, helping them promote responsible ownership practices efficiently.

Pet Owners/ Users of the system:

To aid users by offering organized, easily accessible information about different species, breeds, care requirements, and behavioral traits. It streamlines the decision-making process, saving time and effort while encouraging long-term commitment and ethical adoption practices.

Future Researchers:

To establish a foundation for future studies in animal welfare, human–animal interactions, and technology-assisted adoption systems. The data collected on owner traits, pet characteristics, and matching outcomes can be used as a reference for further research or the development of improved recommendation tools and algorithms in the field.

Scope and Delimitations

This study focuses on promoting responsible pet ownership in the Philippines by addressing key factors that lead to pet neglect and abandonment. It examines how pet-owner compatibility, preparedness for temporary care, and the provision of preventive health measures—such as vaccinations, deworming, and regular veterinary check-ups—contribute to responsible ownership. The research also investigates how web-based educational tools can help pet owners make informed decisions that enhance animal welfare and reduce stray populations.

The study aims to develop a personality-based pet recommendation system that guides individuals in choosing pets suited to their lifestyle, resources, and personality traits, fostering long-term commitment and reducing abandonment. It also seeks to raise awareness on responsible planning for temporary care, emphasize the importance of preventive healthcare, and promote reliance on credible pet care information. Furthermore, it highlights the link between personality compatibility and pet behavior to encourage empathy and lifelong responsibility among pet owners.

The study is limited to animals legally kept as pets in the Philippines. It includes commonly domesticated species such as dogs, cats, birds, ornamental fishes, amphibians, reptiles and small mammals, but excludes rare exotic species, illegal animal trades, or pets not covered within the study's timeframe.

Furthermore, the research is confined to the Philippine context; therefore, findings may not fully apply to other cultural or environmental settings. The system will not include advanced features such as payment integration, live adoption functionalities, or AI-driven behavioral prediction. These enhancements may be considered for future development but remain outside the current scope of this study.

Overall, the study focuses on establishing responsible pet ownership through personality-based recommendations but does not replace professional veterinary or behavioral advice.

CHAPTER II

Related Literature

Responsible pet care and the concept of pet–owner compatibility have grown increasingly prominent in local as well as international literature, especially as communities deal with abandonment, stray populations, and public health concerns. Within the Philippine context, San Jose et al. (2020) carried out a study of the knowledge, behavior, and practice of pet owners in Magellan, Pampanga, and found significant gaps in awareness and application in vaccination and regular veterinary care. Their study highlights that willingness alone is insufficient, with owners' capabilities, as well as their limitations, being important in putting knowledge into practice. Another recent study (Quing et al., 2024) used a sequential explanatory design to further clarify the roles of sociodemographic factors in shaping pet ownership practices in the same location. These Philippine studies present a regional perspective on the environment and address the necessity for local compatibility frameworks that are tailored to local conditions.

Another local work by Macasa & Orbon-Grijalvo (2024) investigated how self-efficacy, the owner–pet relationship, and social support predict pet-owner wellness among Filipino owners. Their findings, showing that self-efficacy accounts for the largest portion of variance in owner wellness (over 30%) while the relationship and social support contribute meaningfully, emphasise that psychological attributes of the owner (confidence, relational quality) are essential in sustaining care.

In the Philippines' pet culture sphere, studies such as the Mars Pet Parent insights reveal that many Filipino owners prefer young or medium-sized pets and often acquire them early in life stages, which suggests widespread expectations about pet size and age that may or may not align with long-term compatibility.

In terms of broader local context, pet ownership rates in the Philippines are high, with a Kantar survey citing that 94% of households own pets, dogs being the majority. This indicates that any system of compatibility must be scalable and relevant to a large population with diverse environments. Also, Chaudhari et al. (2022) studied dog ecology and demographics across Philippine urban, rural, and island settings, revealing how roaming practices, confinement norms, and stray populations vary significantly by geography. Their results imply that environmental and infrastructural constraints must factor into compatibility models.

Additionally, Velasco (2021) highlights the often-overlooked plight of companion animals during disasters in the Philippines. Instances were recorded where animals were left in cages or tied up as floodwaters gradually consumed urban areas. The Philippine Animal Welfare Society (PAWS) issued a reminder to the public to "give animals a fighting chance during disasters" (ABS-CBN News, 2020). When PAWS revisited Provident Village in Marikina City, they discovered the corpses of animals still chained or caged—tragic outcomes of what Heath and Linnabury term "pet evacuation failure," a specific form of abandonment. Velasco's sociological perspective reveals how companion animals are rendered invisible in disaster response efforts, underscoring the urgent need to integrate responsible ownership and disaster preparedness into pet-owner education and compatibility systems.

Another local gap identified in the literature concerns the lack of accessible short-term or temporary care options for pets. Many Filipino pet owners struggle to find trustworthy sitters or fostering programs when facing emergencies, travel, or illness, which often leads to neglect or surrender. Studies abroad show that structured short-term fostering and respite care programs significantly reduce pet abandonment and improve welfare outcomes (Gunter et al., 2023; Phillips & Gunter, 2024). Incorporating such models into compatibility or ownership systems could support owners in maintaining responsible care even during temporary absences.

Furthermore, research underscores the increasing role of digital media in shaping pet care decisions. While online platforms provide accessible advice, misinformation about diet, health, and training remains widespread, often influencing owners' choices in harmful ways. Hussein et al. (2021) and recent animal welfare campaigns emphasize the need for evidence-based educational resources to guide owners. Thus, any compatibility or recommendation system must integrate reliable information and behavioral guidance to counteract misleading online trends.

Turning to international literature, Bender, Bräuer & Schweinberger's (2023) systematic review identifies personality and attachment as core determinants of a functional dog-owner dyad, arguing that traits such as warmth, openness, and agreeable behavior are frequently predictive of better relationships, while avoidant attachment can pose risks.

Relatedly, research on owner-dog similarity, as in "Like owner, like dog" (2024), shows that correlations often appear in extraversion and neuroticism, suggesting that shared traits may develop over time (through emotional convergence) or be selected at the pairing stage.

The study “Dog-Owner Relationship, Owner Interpretations and Dog Emotional Reactivity” used physiological measures (heart rate variability) to show how stronger emotional closeness correlates with lower arousal in dogs during stress, implying that emotional bond quality influences compatibility and welfare under stressed conditions.

Together, these literatures illustrate that compatibility is multidimensional—comprising personality and attachment, environmental constraints, owner psychological traits, behavioral attributes of the animal, and even technological assessment methods. They support the proposition that a well-designed pet-owner matching system needs to integrate these dimensions for meaningful, sustainable recommendations.

Related Studies

Locally, the “PAWrfect Match” system (Torres, de Leon, et al.) is a Philippine-based web adoption platform that uses a user preference survey and matches users to shelter animals based on basic traits and preferences. While promising, its questionnaire focuses on visible preferences (size, age, appearance) and lacks deeper behavioral/personality matching or embedded education modules.

A related local survey in Pampanga (San Jose et al., 2020) also functions as empirical groundwork: though not a matching system, its KAP (knowledge, attitude, and practice) findings remain reference points for many Philippine pet ownership interventions.

Another local study, Macasa & Orbon-Grijalvo (2024), though not an adoption tool, tracked how owners' psychological variables predicted wellness and relational outcomes, offering insights into which owner factors (self-efficacy, attachment) can predict success in pet ownership. In the broader Philippines context, Chaudhari et al. (2022) on dog demographics across regions provides a field dataset that can inform location-sensitive matching systems (e.g., recommending animals adapted to particular environments).

Finally, the Mars Pet Parent insights in the Philippines act as a large-scale consumer behavior "study," revealing adoption trends, owner expectations, and preferences—data that can help calibrate recommendation algorithms.

Internationally, "Meet Your Match" (ASPCA) is perhaps the best-established system: it uses behavioral assessments of animals (canine/feline "alities") plus adopter questionnaires to guide placement and reports lower return rates and better long-term outcomes in many participating shelters."Pet and owner personality and mental wellbeing are associated with attachment" (Finland). It analysed thousands of Finnish owners and found that combinations of owner mental health, unwanted pet behavior, and pet sociability explained variance in attachment styles.

A design prototype, "My Dog Twin," from South Korea matches owners and dogs using traits and appearance, demonstrating how interactive digital matching can engage adopters (though its scientific rigor is not peer-reviewed).

Finally, the "Quantified Canine" study (Meegahapola et al.), which creates predictive models from wearables, is also the sort of system study that points toward future automated matching systems.

Synthesis

The reviewed literature and studies collectively emphasize that responsible pet ownership is a complex concept shaped by psychological, behavioral, environmental, and technological factors. Local research highlights that many Filipino pet owners demonstrate affection and willingness to care for their pets but often lack the necessary knowledge, resources, and preparedness to sustain responsible ownership. These studies reveal gaps in awareness of preventive healthcare, limited access to temporary pet care, and the absence of structured compatibility frameworks suited to Philippine conditions.

Meanwhile, international studies expand the discussion by showing that personality traits and attachment styles significantly influence pet-owner compatibility and long-term welfare. Compatibility-based systems, such as *Meet Your Match*, and data-driven approaches like *Quantified Canine* demonstrate the potential of integrating behavioral science and technology in improving pet adoption outcomes. However, these systems are mostly applied in foreign contexts, focusing either on animal behavior or adopter preferences, and rarely combine personality-based matching with educational guidance and contextual factors like culture, environment, and available care options.

The reviewed body of work emphasizes the growing need for a comprehensive, adaptive framework that bridges psychological understanding and digital innovation. It shows that while prior research establishes the importance of compatibility and responsibility, there remains a gap in applying these concepts in a way that is locally relevant, accessible, and preventive in nature.

In response to these gaps, the study **PetSona: A Personality-Based Pet Recommendation System to Promote Responsible Pet Ownership and Reduce Pet Abandonment**, which differs from previous research by integrating personality alignment, lifestyle assessment, and educational guidance within a single system tailored to Filipino pet owners. Unlike earlier models that focus solely on preference-based matching or general awareness, PetSona emphasizes psychological compatibility, preparedness for temporary care, preventive healthcare awareness, and access to credible pet care information. Through this approach, the study not only promotes responsible ownership and reduces abandonment but also contributes a culturally relevant, technology-supported framework for improving animal welfare and fostering compassionate, informed relationships between pets and their owners.

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Appendices

Appendix A. Authorization and Request Letters

CITY COLLEGE OF SAN FERNANDO PAMPANGA
City of San Fernando, Pampanga
INSTITUTE OF INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY

Date: Sept. 9, 2025

DR. RYAN PAUL MANLAPAZ
City Veterinarian,
City Agriculture and Veterinary Office
San Fernando, Pampanga

Dear Dr. Manlapaz,

Greetings!

We, the undersigned fourth-year **Bachelor of Science in Information Technology** students from the **City College of San Fernando Pampanga**, are presently undertaking our capstone project entitled **"A Personality-Based Pet Recommendation System to Promote Responsible Pet Ownership"** as part of the academic requirements for our Capstone 1 course.

In line with this, we respectfully seek your participation in our data-gathering activities through surveys and/or interviews. Since the scope of this study is limited to respondents within the **Philippines**, your professional insights and experiences will serve as a valuable contribution in ensuring the accuracy, relevance, and reliability of the study's findings.

Rest assured that all information obtained will be handled with the utmost confidentiality and will be used solely for academic and research purposes. We are fully committed to safeguarding the privacy and integrity of all responses throughout the conduct of this study.

We sincerely hope for your favorable consideration of this request and look forward to your support in making this endeavor a success.

Thank you for your time and kind attention.

Respectfully,

KIM CHRISTLE C. BIEN
Proponent

JOSEPHINE G. GONZALES
Proponent

JERICHO M. SALAS
Proponent

Endorsed by:

MAYBELL L. PANLAQUI, MIT
Capstone Project Adviser

Reviewed and noted by:

RONALIZA V. DOMINGO
Capstone Coordinator

CITY COLLEGE OF SAN FERNANDO PAMPANGA
City of San Fernando, Pampanga
INSTITUTE OF INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY

Date: Sept. 09, 2025

To Whom It May Concern:

Greetings!

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We sincerely hope for your favorable consideration of this request and look forward to your support in making this endeavor a success.

Thank you for your time and kind attention.

Respectfully,

KIM CHRISTLE C. BIEN
Proponent

JOSEPHINE G. GONZALES
Proponent

JERICHO M. SALAS
Proponent

Endorsed by:

MAYBELL L. PANLAQUI, MIT
Capstone Project Adviser

Reviewed and noted by:

RONALIZA V. DOMINGO
Capstone Coordinator

Appendix B. Questionnaire

Title: Veterinarians' Questionnaire on Pet Ownership

Purpose:

This section aims to gather insights from veterinarians on factors affecting responsible pet ownership, including health management, owner preparedness, and the causes and prevention of pet abandonment.

1. Full Name (Optional):

2. Years of Practice as a Veterinarian.

3. Primary Species/Animal Groups You Commonly Handle (check all that apply):

☐ Companion animals (Dogs, Cats)

☐ Birds (Parrots, Lovebirds, etc.)

☐ Reptiles & Amphibians (Lizards, Frogs, Turtles)

☐ Small Mammals (Rabbits, Guinea pigs, Hamsters, Rats)

☐ Ornamental Fish (Koi, Goldfish, Betta, etc.)

☐ Others (please specify):

Scale Guide: 1 – Not important, 2 – Slightly important, 3 – Moderate, 4 – Important, 5 – Very important.

4. How important is an owner's age and physical condition (e.g., elderly, young children, people with health problems) when selecting a suitable pet?

1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5 ☐

5. How important is the owner's lifestyle (e.g., active vs. sedentary, always home vs. often away) in determining the right kind of pet?

1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5 ☐

6. How important is following a vaccination schedule to ensure pet health and prevent risks if neglected?

1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5 ☐

7. From a veterinary standpoint, how often should pets undergo regular check-ups depending on species or breed?

8. What grooming requirements should owners be aware of for common pet breeds/species?

9. How does the owner's availability or presence at home affect pet compatibility (e.g., companion needs, risk of separation anxiety)?

10. Are there specific pets that are more suitable for owners who are often away from home (e.g., due to work)?

11. What environmental factors (e.g., apartment vs. house, rural vs. urban setting) should be considered when recommending a pet?

12. How do you educate owners about the long-term commitment (e.g., lifespan, cost, medical care) of different pets?

13. How would you describe the typical temperament and care requirements of common pet species (e.g., dogs, cats, birds, rabbits)?

14. From a health perspective, what common allergies or medical conditions should be considered before choosing a pet?

15. Are there specific pets or breeds that are generally hypoallergenic or safer for people with asthma or respiratory issues?

16. Do you or your clinic provide boarding services where pets can stay overnight (e.g., during owner's travel or emergencies)? If yes, please describe the services you provide:

17. With the overwhelming volume of online resources, pet owners often struggle to identify credible guidance. In your experience, how does this affect pet health and welfare, and how do you address it as a veterinarian?

Title: Pet Shop Owners / Staff Questionnaire

Purpose:

This section aims to explore pet shop owners' and staff's observations on customer behavior, pet selection patterns, and the potential use of personality-based recommendations to encourage responsible ownership.

1. Role in the Pet Shop.

2. How many years have you worked in the pet industry?

3. How often do customers ask for guidance when selecting a pet?

☐ Rarely

☐ Sometimes

☐ Often

☐ Almost always

4. What types of questions do customers usually ask when choosing a pet?

5. Have you noticed patterns where customers with certain lifestyles or professions (e.g., students, families with kids, elderly, working professionals) prefer specific types of pets?

☐ Frequently

☐ Sometimes

☐ Rarely

☐ Never

6. Do you or your staff provide recommendations based on a customer's lifestyle or personality?

☐ Yes

☐ No

7. What are the most common compatibility issues or mismatches you have observed between pets and their owners?

8. Are there certain pets or species that are often returned or rehomed due to compatibility concerns?

9. In your opinion, would incorporating a personality assessment improve customer satisfaction and long-term success in pet adoption?

10. What improvements would you suggest to ensure better owner-pet matching in pet shops?

11. Do you or your clinic provide boarding services where pets can stay overnight (e.g., during owner's travel or emergencies)? If yes, please describe the services you provide:

Title: Psychologist or Behavioral Expert Questionnaire

Purpose:

This section seeks professional insights on how personality traits influence pet compatibility and how psychological principles can guide responsible ownership.

1. Full Name (Optional):
2. From a psychological perspective, which personality traits are most relevant when determining compatibility between a person and a pet?
3. How do personality frameworks (e.g., Big Five, MBTI) influence lifestyle choices that may relate to pet ownership?
4. What psychological benefits, if any, are commonly linked to specific pet types for certain personality profiles?
5. In your training or experience, have you encountered cases where a person's mental health improved or declined due to pet ownership? What were the factors?
6. In what ways do introverted and extroverted individuals differ in their pet preferences and interactions?
7. What potential psychological risks may arise from mismatching pets and owners based on personality traits?
8. How might psychological assessments be structured to effectively guide pet-owner compatibility?
9. What challenges do you foresee in developing a pet-compatibility model based on human psychology?
10. Can you share examples, without disclosing confidential information, where psychological insights significantly influenced a pet-related decision?

11. What ethical considerations should be prioritized when using psychological profiling for pet recommendations?

Title: Pet Owner Questionnaire

Purpose:

This section aims to understand pet owners' experiences, lifestyles, and openness to digital tools that promote responsible ownership and compatibility.

1. Name (Optional):

2. Age Group:

☐ Below 18

☐ 18-25

☐ 26-35

☐ 36-45

☐ 46 and above

3. Gender:

☐ Male

☐ Female

☐ Other:

4. Where are you located? (Barangay, City)

5. What types of pet(s) do you currently own?

6. How long have you been a pet owner?

☐ Less than 1 year

☐ 1 - 3 years

☐ 4 - 6 years

☐ 7 years and above

7. What were your main reasons for choosing your current pet(s)?

8. Did you consider your lifestyle or personality before choosing your pet?

9. How would you describe your personality?

Scale Guide: 1 – Not Compatible at all - 5 – Perfectly Compatible

10. On a scale of 1 - 5, how compatible do you feel you are with your current pet(s)?

1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5 ☐

11. How much time are you usually at home with your pet(s)?

12. Do you believe your home provides adequate space for your pet(s)?

☐ Yes

☐ No

13. How often do you bring your pet to the vet for regular check-ups?

☐ Never

☐Once a year

☐ Twice a year

☐ More than twice a year

14. Are your pet(s) up to date with their vaccination?

☐ Yes

☐ No

☐ Not sure

15. How do you handle grooming needs for your pet(s)?

☐ At home

☐ Professional grooming service

☐ Others:

16. Would you consider using a system that matches pets to owners based on personality and lifestyle?

☐ Yes

☐ No

☐ Maybe

Appendix C. Survey and Interview Results with Interpretation

Pet Owner

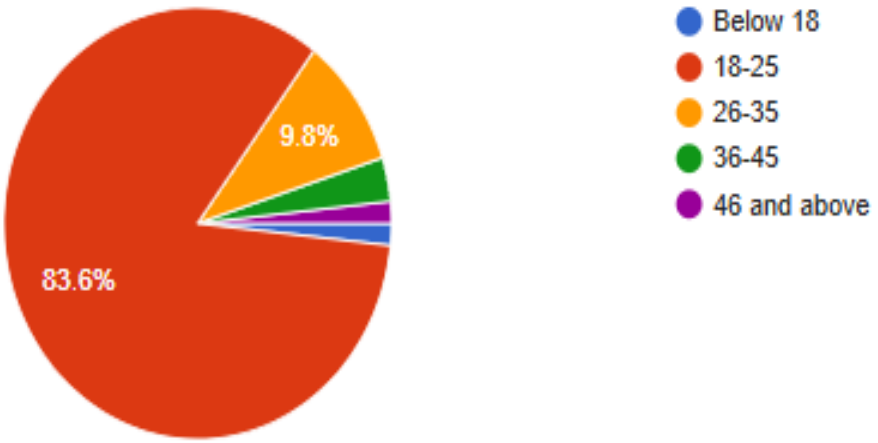

Figure 1: Age Group

The age categories of pet owners are shown in Figure 1. Based on the chart, 83.6% of pet owners are between the ages of 18 and 25. Those between the ages of 26 and 35 came in second with 9.8%. Very few pet owners are younger than 18, between the ages of 36 and 45, or older than 46. This indicates that, in comparison to other age groups, young adults are the largest group of pet owners.

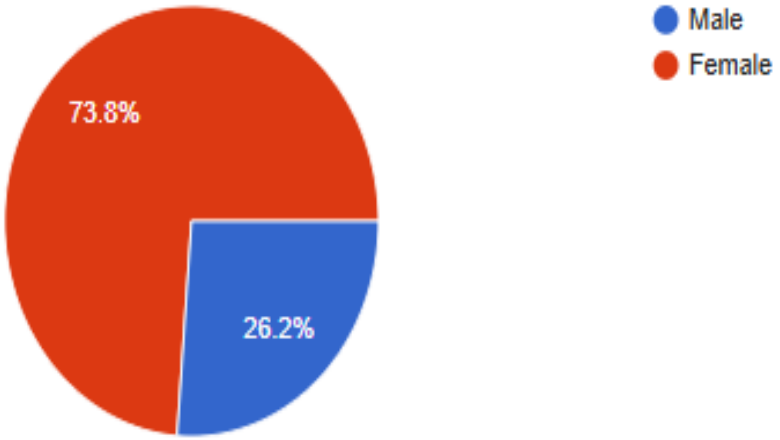

Figure 2: Gender

Pet owners' gender distribution is displayed in Figure 2. According to the chart, 26.2% of people are men and 73.8% are women. To make the survey gender inclusive, it had an "others" option, although no answers were found under that heading. Accordingly, women own pets at a higher rate than men.

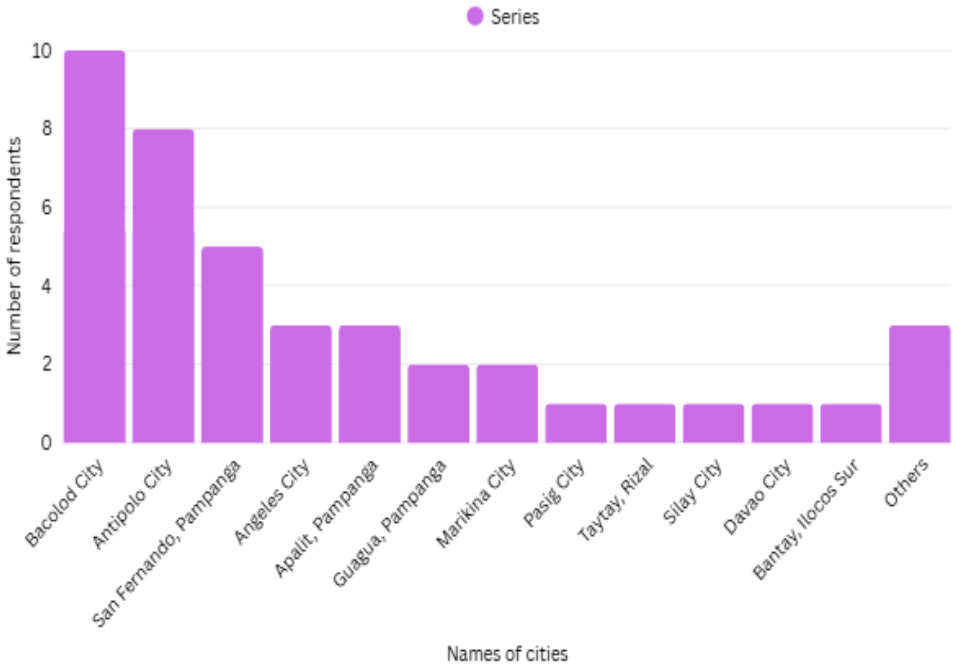

Figure 3: Location (Barangay, City)

Based on Figure 3, most survey respondents came from Bacolod City and Antipolo City, showing that pet ownership is more common in highly urbanized areas. Participants from Pampanga (San Fernando, Angeles, and Apalit) also reflect growing interest in responsible pet care outside major cities. The fewer responses from Marikina, Pasig, and Davao suggest limited survey reach or lower engagement among pet owners in those areas.

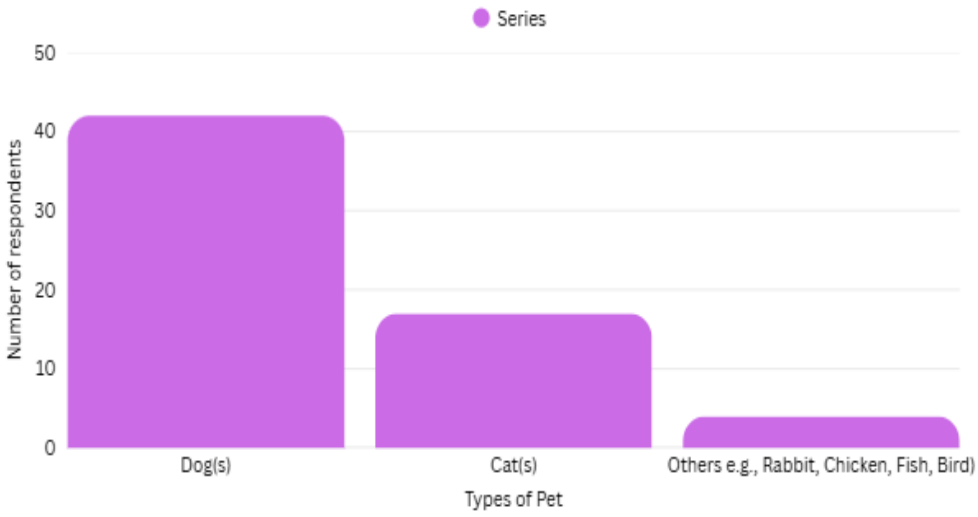

Figure 4: Types of Pet

In Figure 4, the bar graph displays the various pet kinds that respondents owned. It is the most common pet, with most of them owning dogs. Only a small percentage of responders have cats as pets, and even fewer have other pets such as fish, birds, chickens, or rabbits. According to this, dogs are the most popular pets, followed by cats and other animals.

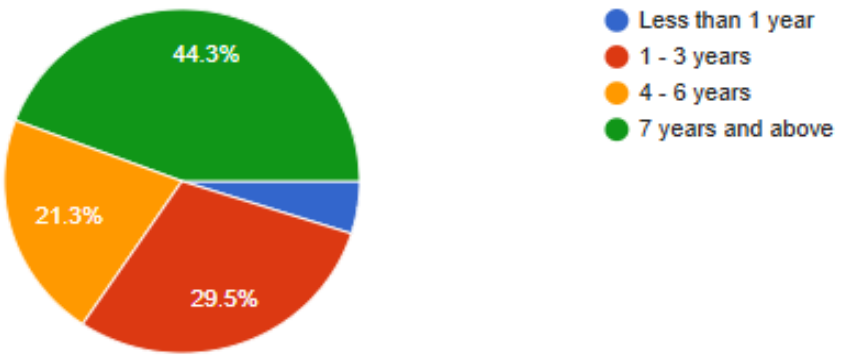

Figure 5: Length of Pet Ownership

The time frame of respondents who have owned pets is displayed in Figure 5. Many people have years of expertise caring for animals, as evidenced by the largest group, 44.3%, who have owned pets for seven years or more. On the other hand, 21.3% have owned a pet for four to six years, and 29.5% have done so for one to three years. Just 4.9% of people have had pets for less than a year. This indicates that the majority of responders have owned pets for a long time and have provided for them.

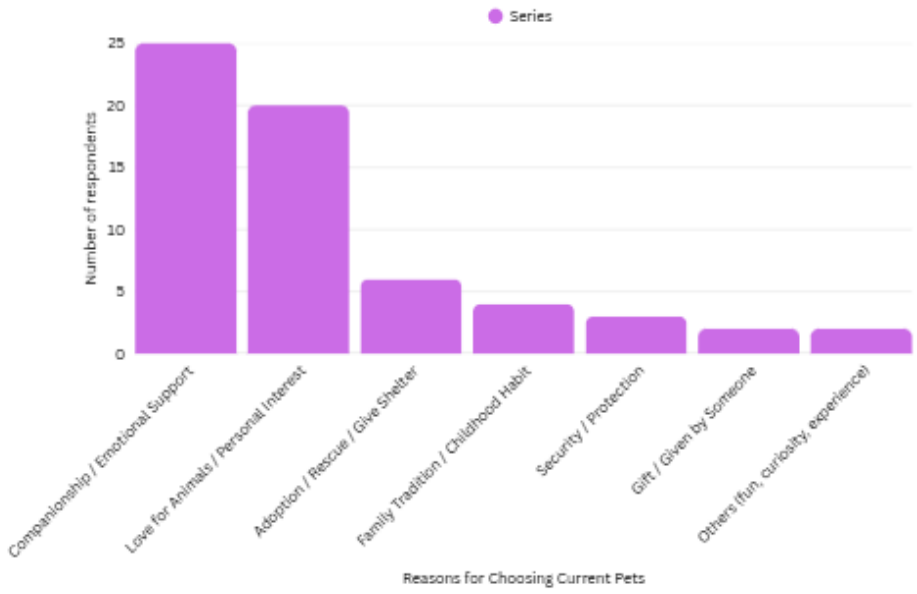

Figure 6: Reasons for Choosing Pet

Based on Figure 6, the majority of respondents claimed companionship and emotional support as the primary reasons they adopted pets. A lot of people also mentioned how much they were motivated by their love of animals. Some respondents stated security, family customs, or just wanting to have fun, while others said they adopted their pets to provide them with a place to live. This implies that the majority of pet owners see their animals as providers of affection, comfort, and emotional connection.

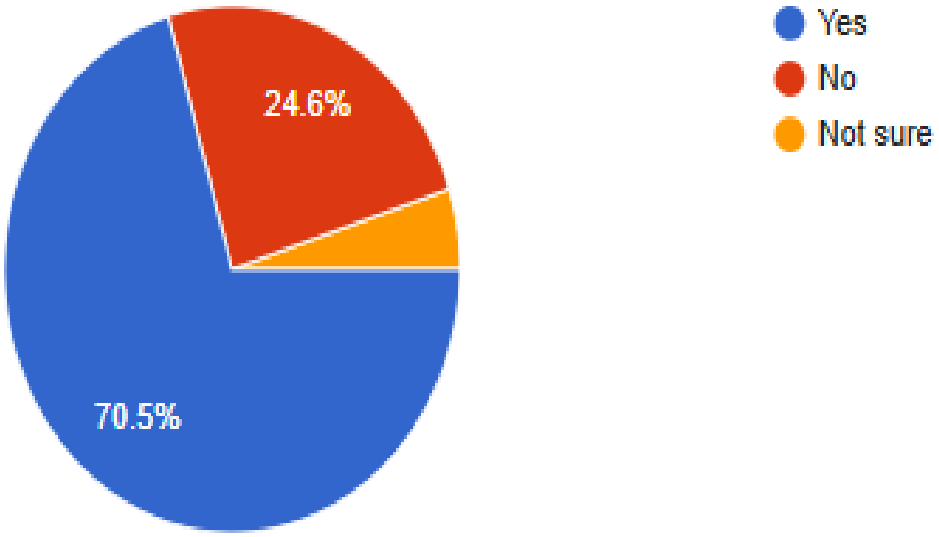

Figure 7: Consideration of Lifestyle or Personality Before Choosing a Pet

Figure 7 displays whether respondents took personality or lifestyle into consideration when selecting their pets. 70.5% of respondents said "Yes," indicating that most pet owners considered how their lifestyle will match with the kind of pet they selected. It appears that most pet owners carefully analyze their compatibility with their pets before making a decision. Meanwhile, 24.6% of respondents replied "No," while a minor percentage, 4.9%, said "Not sure."

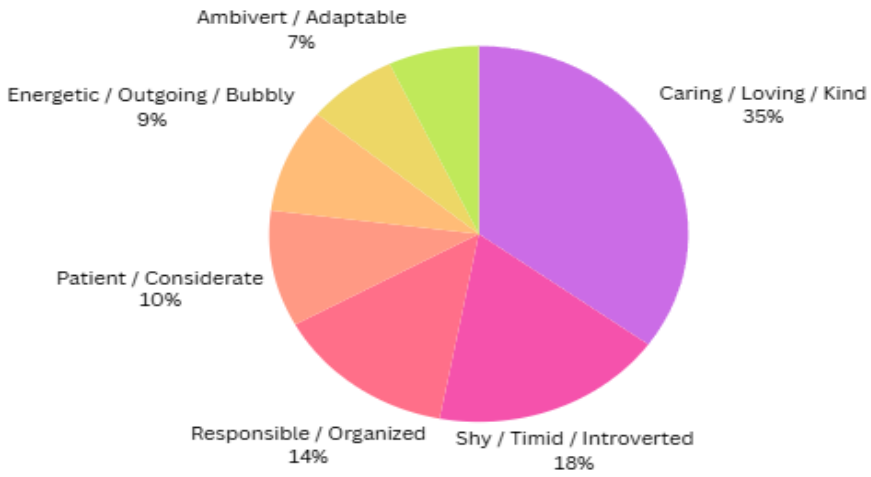

Figure 8: Respondents' Personality Descriptions

According to the responses, the majority of participants have nurturing and compassionate personalities, as evidenced by the 35% of participants who identified as caring, loving, or kind. According to 18% of respondents, they are introverted, shy, or timid, which may indicate that they favor quiet, peaceful environments. 10% identified as patient or considerate, while 14% said they were responsible or organized. Meanwhile, 9% described themselves as energetic, outgoing, or bubbly, while 7% described themselves as ambiverts or adaptable. Furthermore, 7% of respondents provided unique responses, such as being busy, moody, or humorous. In general, the findings demonstrate that the majority of respondents have responsible, compassionate, and kind personalities, qualities that are indicators of responsible pet ownership.

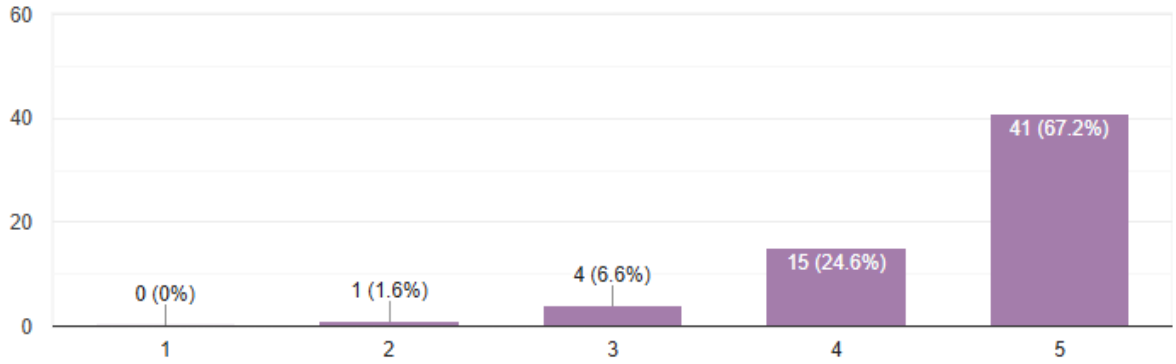

Figure 9: Compatibility with Current Pets

According to the findings, the majority of respondents gave their compatibility with their current pets an excellent rating. They feel very comfortable with their pets, as seen by the 67.2% who gave it a 5. A significant good relationship was indicated by the 24.6% who rated it as 4. 1.6% gave it a rating of 2, 0% gave it a rating of 1, and a smaller percentage, 6.6%, gave it a rating of 3, indicating moderate compatibility. In general, the evidence points to a strong link and compatibility between most pet owners and their animals, which is indicative of responsible ownership and healthy connections.

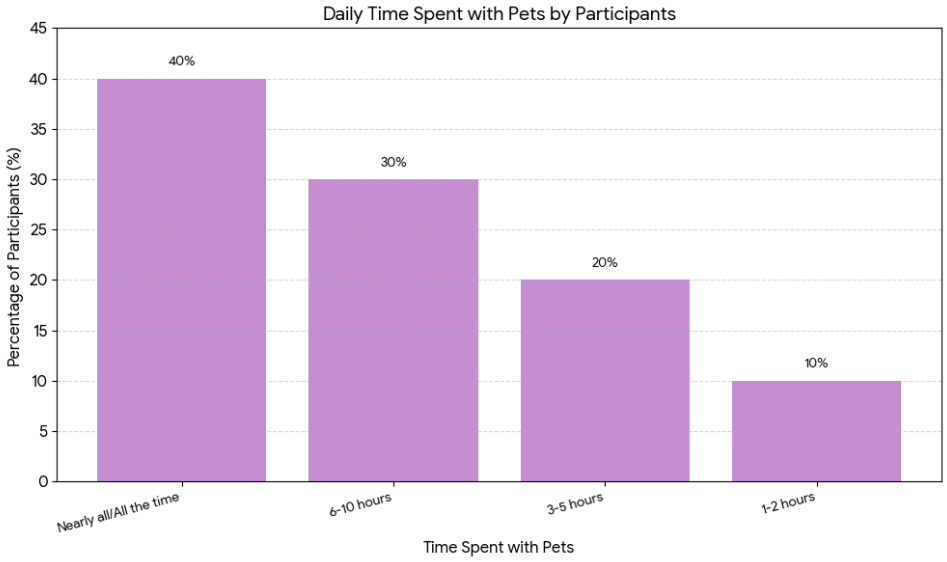

Figure 10: Time Spent at Home with Pets

The majority of participants spend a considerable amount of time with their pets every day, based on the results. About 40% of those surveyed stated that they spend nearly all of their time with their pets or around all the time, demonstrating their closeness and availability. Thirty percent of respondents reported spending 6-10 hours a day with their pets, frequently before or after work or school. 20% more people identified as spending 3-5 hours at home with their pets, compared to 10% who only spent 1-2 hours due to work or other obligations. According to the analysis, most respondents spend enough time with their pets overall, allowing for frequent care and engagement that fosters a positive relationship and responsible pet ownership.

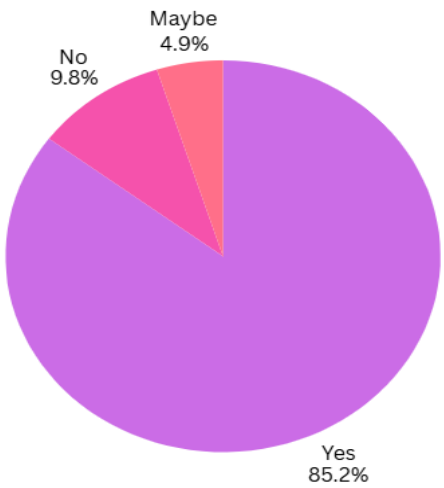

Figure 11: Adequacy of Home Space for Pets

According to the findings, 85.2% of respondents selected "Yes," meaning that there is enough room in their homes for their dogs. In contrast, 4.9% of respondents indicated "Maybe," indicating a degree of uncertainty regarding the suitability of their home, while 9.8% said "No," indicating little room for pet activities. Therefore, the results indicate that most respondents reside in pet-friendly homes where their animals may roam around freely and be healthy.

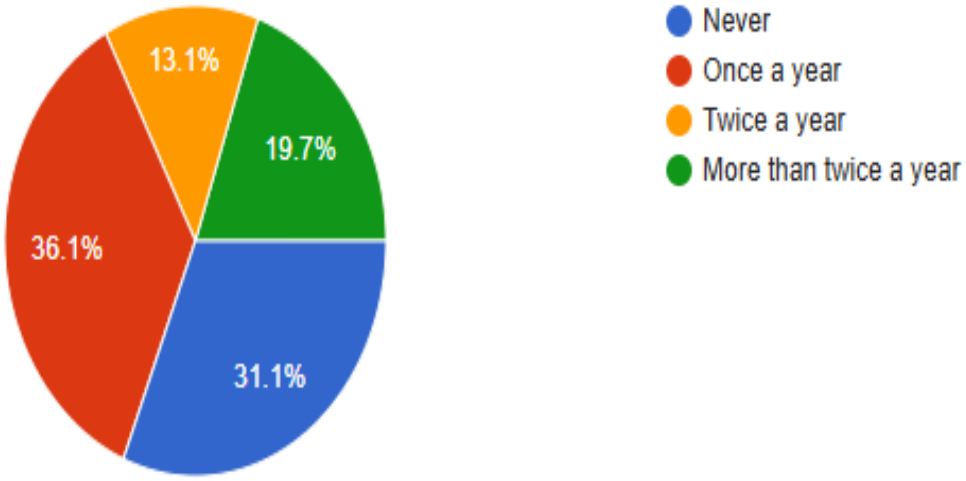

Figure 12: Frequency of Pet Check-ups

According to the data, 31.1% of respondents stated they never bring their pets for checkups, while 36.1% of respondents take their pets to the vet once a year. In contrast, 19.7% bring their pets more than twice a year, and 13.1% take them to the veterinarian twice a year. In general, the findings show that a significant percentage of pet owners still skip routine veterinary checkups, even though many make sure their animals have at least yearly checkups. This highlights the importance of promoting regular pet healthcare and preventative care.

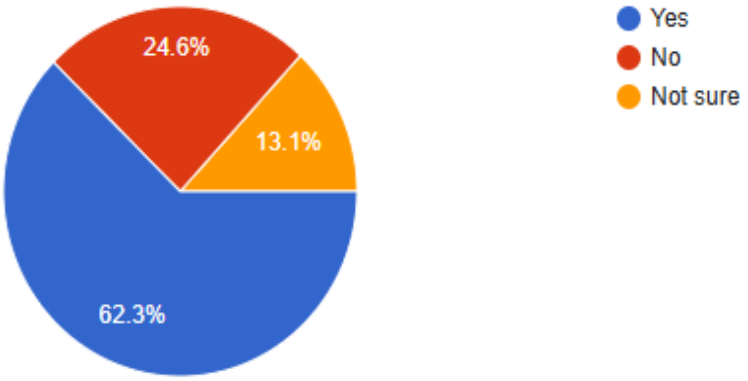

Figure 13: Pet Vaccination Status

According to the chart, 62.3% of respondents said their pets' vaccinations are current, demonstrating a high level of knowledge about pet health and illness prevention. In the meantime, 13.1% of respondents were unsure of their pets' vaccination status, and 24.6% acknowledged that their pets were unvaccinated. In general, the findings highlight the need for more education on responsible pet healthcare and the need of vaccinations, even if the majority of pet owners maintain appropriate vaccinations. A significant portion, however, still lack awareness or consistency.

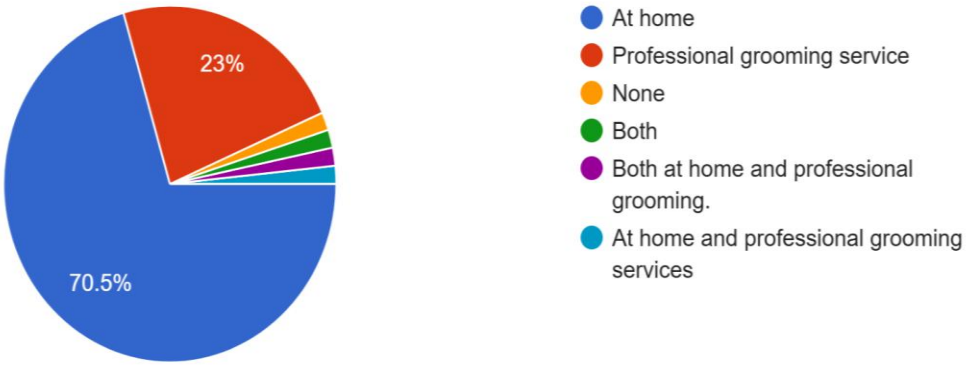

Figure 14: Methods of Pet Grooming Among Respondents

According to the findings, the majority of respondents (70.5%) groom their pets at home, implying that most pet owners prefer personal care and are confident in maintaining their pets' hygiene themselves. Meanwhile, 23% employ professional grooming services, indicating that some owners rely on skilled care for their pets. A tiny proportion of respondents (6.5%) either combine home and professional grooming or do not groom their pets at all. Overall, the results show that the majority of pet owners are hands-on and involved in their pets' grooming, demonstrating responsibility and attention to pet care.

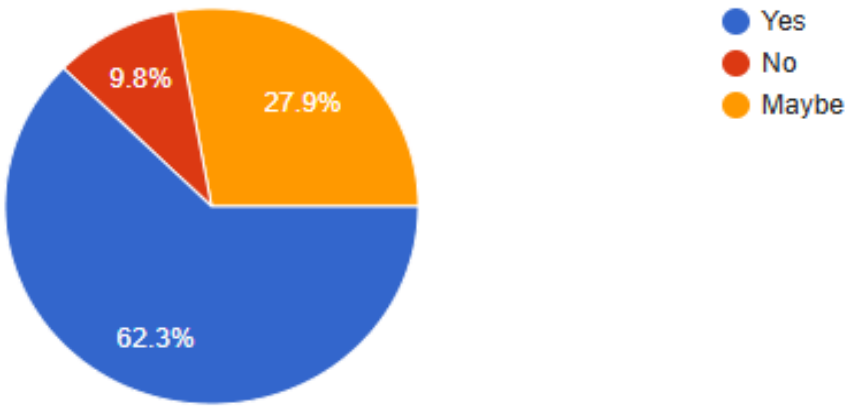

Figure 15: Willingness to Use a Pet–Owner Matching System

According to the analysis, 62.3% of respondents said "Yes," demonstrating a high desire to use a system that connects pet owners with pets according to lifestyle and personality characteristics. 9.8% of respondents said "No," indicating that they prefer traditional ways of selecting pets, while 27.9% said "Maybe," indicating openness but some uncertainty. Therefore, the findings indicate that the majority of respondents have favorable opinions about modern methods of ethical pet management and are open to technology-assisted pet matching.

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Results from Veterinarians' Interview

1. Importance of Owner's Age, Lifestyle, and Preparedness

Both Doc Yssa and Doc Poy said that the lifestyle, age, and daily routine of a pet owner are very important when choosing a pet.

Doc Yssa explained that some pets, like cats, are more independent, but others such as rabbits, guinea pigs, and hamsters are social animals that get lonely if left alone for too long. She said that some rabbits even die because they are left alone with no companion. This shows that the time and attention a person can give should always be considered before getting a pet.

Doc Poy also said that age and physical condition matter. For example, elderly people or very young children should not have large or strong dogs like Bullmastiffs as they may not be able to handle them properly. He also added that active breeds, such as Labradors or Belgian Malinois, need more space and exercise. If they are kept in small areas, they can become restless, destructive, or even try to escape.

Interpretation:

Both veterinarians believe that choosing the right pet depends on the owner's lifestyle, physical ability, and amount of free time. If these factors do not match, pets may be neglected or develop behavior problems. Responsible ownership starts with knowing what kind of pet truly fits one's lifestyle and home situation.

2. Environment and Space Requirements

When asked about living space, Doc Yssa explained that the environment must be suitable for the type of pet. For example, cats need climbing areas or "vertical spaces" such as shelves or cat towers. Owners should not stop them from climbing but instead give them a safe place to do so.

Dogs, especially big ones, need outdoor spaces like grassy areas where they can run and exercise. Lack of movement can cause health problems. For exotic pets like hamsters or rabbits, she said they should not be kept alone and should have space to interact with other animals. She also mentioned that noise levels should be considered, especially for pets that are sensitive to loud sounds.

Doc Poy agreed that space is very important. He shared that some city ordinances even have rules about how much space each pet should have. He explained that dogs that are full of energy must have areas to move around. Without enough space, they might become hard to handle or even escape from their cages.

Interpretation:

Both veterinarians said that a pet's environment should fit its natural behavior and exercise needs. Limited space can cause stress and sickness. Therefore, having proper space and a suitable environment is a big part of being a responsible pet owner.

3. Health Care and Vaccination

On health management, both doctors agreed that vaccination and regular check-ups are very important.

Doc Yssa said that vaccines, especially rabies vaccines, must be given on time because the Philippines is not yet a rabies-free country. She said that preventive care is better than treating pets only when they are sick. She recommended that pets visit the vet every six months, or at least once a year, for general check-ups and blood tests.

Doc Poy said that in their clinic (City Agriculture and Veterinary Office), they follow a routine schedule: deworming every three months, vaccination every six months, and a check-up once a year. He added that owners should only trust licensed veterinarians for proper vaccine timing and not rely on unverified information.

Interpretation:

Both veterinarians stress that prevention is better than cure. Regular vet visits, proper vaccines, and preventive care protect not only the pet but also the owner and community from diseases like rabies.

4. Allergies and Health Concerns

Doc Yssa said that the most common allergies in dogs and cats come from fleas and food (such as chicken or beef). She also shared that some breeds, like French Bulldogs, often have breathing problems because of their flat faces, while large dogs like German Shepherds may have hip or bone problems. Due to these risks, she advised pet owners to be financially ready for possible medical emergencies.

Doc Poy, on the other hand, discussed human allergies. He said that some people are allergic to pet fur or dander, so it is better for them to choose short-haired or less-shedding dogs. This is especially important for people with asthma or other breathing problems.

Interpretation:

Both veterinarians explained that health must be considered for both the pet and the owner. Owners should know the possible diseases, allergies, and medical costs that come with certain breeds before deciding to keep them.

5. Educating Pet Owners

When it comes to educating pet owners, Doc Yssa said she focuses on preventive care and good communication. She said owners should find a veterinarian they are comfortable with, since it is easier to follow advice when there is trust. She even said that "vet hopping" is okay if it helps owners find the right vet who matches their communication style.

Doc Poy added that pet ownership requires financial and emotional stability. He said that owners must be ready to provide the basics like food, shelter, vaccination, and medical care for the whole lifetime of the pet.

Interpretation:

Both veterinarians believe that educating owners is an important part of their job. They see themselves not only as animal doctors but also as guides who help owners make better choices for their pets.

6. Online Information and Misinformation

Doc Yssa said that many pet owners today rely on social media influencers for pet care advice, which can be risky. She shared that just last week, a few pet owners came to her clinic saying, "Doc, sabi nung influencer sa TikTok, masama raw ang fish sa cats." She explained that while some cats can have allergies to certain proteins like fish, it is not true that fish is automatically bad for all cats. The problem, she said, is that many people online make general statements without scientific proof or veterinary background.

She emphasized that pet owners should always fact-check information they see online and, if possible, ask the source to provide credible references. According to her, reliable information can be verified through official government veterinary websites or legitimate animal welfare organizations. She also mentioned that there are websites where pet owners can validate claims about pet health and products before trying them on their animals.

Doc Poy said that misinformation spreads fast, especially when people follow trends without consulting professionals. He added that sometimes owners experiment with treatments or diets they see online, which can harm their pets. He advised that before trying anything new, pet owners should ask a licensed veterinarian to confirm if the information is safe and applicable.

Interpretation:

Online misinformation affects pet welfare as some owners follow advice that is not based on science. Both veterinarians stressed the importance of verifying information through credible sources and consulting professionals. Veterinarians play a key role in correcting false beliefs and helping owners find trustworthy pet care guidance.

7. Behavior and Socialization

Doc Yssa explained that most aggressive behavior in pets comes from fear, not anger. She said that many owners misunderstand “socialization.” Taking pets to malls or cafés is not real socialization. Instead, it means slowly introducing them to different people, sounds, and situations while they are still young.

If pets are not socialized properly, they may react with fear or aggression later in life. She stressed that owners should understand animal behavior, read body language, and respect boundaries.

Doc Poy said that lack of training and socialization is a common cause of biting incidents. He shared that some owners only notice behavioral issues when their pets are already adults, making it harder to fix. He recommends starting socialization as early as 2–3 months old and pairing it with positive reinforcement like treats or gentle praise. According to him, consistent interaction helps build trust between pets and owners, reducing stress and aggression.

Interpretation:

Behavior problems can be prevented through early training and proper socialization. When owners fail to understand pet behavior, it can lead to fear, biting, or even abandonment. Teaching owners to respect their pets' boundaries and provide positive early experiences can improve the animal's well-being.

8. Causes and Prevention of Pet Abandonment

Doc Poy shared that one common reason for pet abandonment is unwanted pregnancies because owners do not spay or neuter their pets. When these animals give birth, owners surrender them to clinics or shelters that may not have enough space to care for them. He also said that many owners underestimate how much time, money, and effort it takes to raise a pet responsibly. Some even abandon pets when they get sick or grow older because they are no longer "cute" or manageable.

Doc Yssa said that emotional unpreparedness is also a big factor. Some people adopt pets out of impulse—like after seeing a cute video online—without considering the long-term care needed. She explained that educating owners about spaying, neutering, and long-term commitment can reduce abandonment cases. She also encouraged pet owners to think carefully before adopting and to be sure they can handle both the happy and challenging parts of pet ownership.

Interpretation:

Pet abandonment often happens as owners are not prepared or lack awareness about pet population control. Both veterinarians highlighted that educating owners about spaying, neutering, and long-term responsibility is key to preventing abandonment and stray animal problems.

Interpretation of Responses: Psychologist or Behavioral Expert Questionnaire Respondents:

- **Maria Victoria S. Garcia, RGC. RPm**
- **Krystal David, RPm**

The responses suggest a clear understanding that personality traits play a crucial role in determining compatibility between humans and pets. From a psychological perspective, traits such as introversion, extroversion, conscientiousness, emotional stability, and attachment style influence not only the type of pet an individual prefers but also how they interact with and care for their companion animal.

Respondents emphasized that personality frameworks, such as the Big Five, provide valuable insight into how lifestyle and behavioral tendencies relate to pet ownership.

For instance, extroverted individuals, who are generally sociable and energetic, tend to prefer pets like dogs that enjoy outdoor activities and social engagement. In contrast, introverted individuals often favor calmer, more independent animals like cats, which align with their need for quiet companionship and minimal stimulation.

Psychological benefits were also identified as mutual and reinforcing — pets can provide emotional balance, companionship, and routine, helping to stabilize their owners' mental health. However, the respondent also noted that mental health outcomes can vary. For example, introverts might experience fatigue when caring for high-energy pets, while extroverts could feel rejected or frustrated when owning less interactive animals. This shows that pet ownership can both enhance and challenge an individual's psychological well-being, depending on the degree of compatibility.

The responses also highlighted potential psychological risks of mismatched pairings, such as stress, fatigue, behavioral conflicts, and financial strain. These arise when the owner's personality and the pet's temperament do not align — for instance, when a low-energy owner adopts a highly active pet, or when an extrovert expects affection from a reserved animal.

To address such issues, the respondent recommended that psychological assessments for pet-owner compatibility should include measures of personality, emotional readiness, and lifestyle stability, alongside factors such as the animal's breed, temperament, and health. However, the respondent also acknowledged the limitations of such models — both human and animal behaviors evolve over time, making long-term predictability difficult.

To conclude, ethical considerations were emphasized. Psychological profiling must prioritize empathy, fairness, and the welfare of both humans and animals.

Pets should not be treated as mere accessories but as living beings whose needs and emotions deserve equal respect. The ultimate goal of compatibility assessment is to create mutually beneficial relationships that support emotional, physical, and mental well-being for both owner and pet.

Interpretation (Pet Shop Owners / Staff Questionnaire and Interviews)

Respondents:

- **Pampanga Animal Hospital**
- **RC Vet Production & Agri. Inc.**
- **Pet Matters**
- **KSC Animalia Pet Shop**
- **PetEternity**
- **Local Pet Vendor (Old Public Market near Pandayan Bookshop, CSFP)**

The data gathered from the pet shop owners and staff reveal varied levels of engagement when it comes to promoting responsible pet ownership and ensuring compatibility between pets and potential owners.

From the interviews, several patterns emerged. Some pet shops focus primarily on sales transactions rather than assessing whether a customer's lifestyle, available space, or resources are suited to a particular pet.

Owners reported that they rarely ask about home environment or living space, and instead, simply provide the animal that the customer prefers.

This indicates that economic motivation often outweighs welfare considerations, resulting in minimal attention to long-term compatibility between pet and owner.

Most shop owners stated that their main guidance occurs only when customers ask questions—usually concerning pet care, feeding, or grooming. This reactive approach means that responsible ownership education is dependent on customer initiative, rather than being part of the pet shop's standard practice. Consequently, first-time owners may purchase animals without fully understanding their needs, leading to potential neglect, poor health, or eventual rehoming.

Regarding grooming and vaccination practices, most pet shops emphasized that these responsibilities are left to the pet owner's discretion. While they sometimes recommend veterinary clinics or vaccination sites when asked, the majority do not offer in-house vaccination services, including rabies vaccination. Their services tend to focus more on grooming and basic care supplies rather than on medical or preventive health aspects.

One owner specializing in fish and small animals (hamsters) explained that these species generally require less maintenance and no vaccination, focusing instead on proper feeding, water treatment, and hygiene. However, for shops that sell dogs or cats, the lack of structured vaccination protocols highlights a gap in animal health management and responsible sale practices.

Overall, the findings suggest that while many pet shops are knowledgeable about pet care, their level of responsibility ends at the point of sale. Compatibility assessments based on personality or lifestyle are rarely practiced, and most rely solely on customer preference. This commercialized approach can result in mismatched adoptions, improper care, and higher risks of abandonment.